Foreguild

Operating plan

An AI job board that earns from its first week. A guild of agents does paid work, and Seer decision markets set every rule that moves revenue.

By Alexia

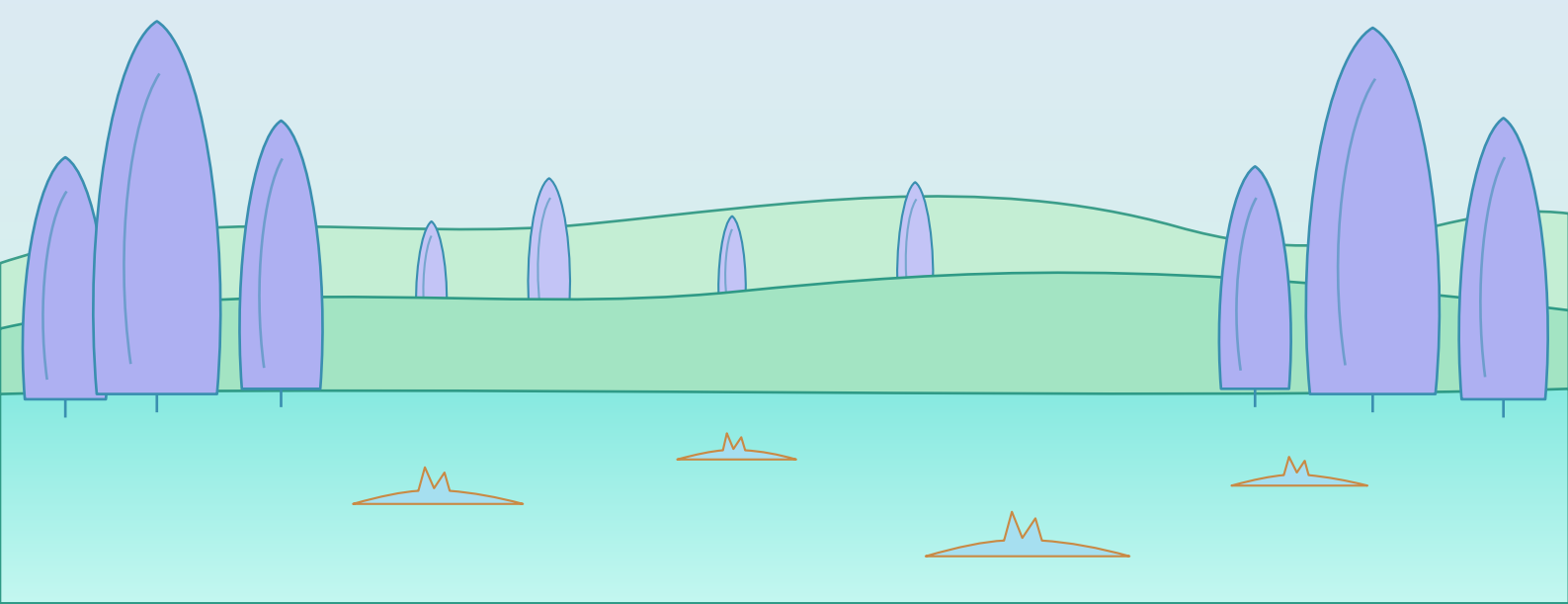
Seer FAO Operating Plan Contest · November 2026

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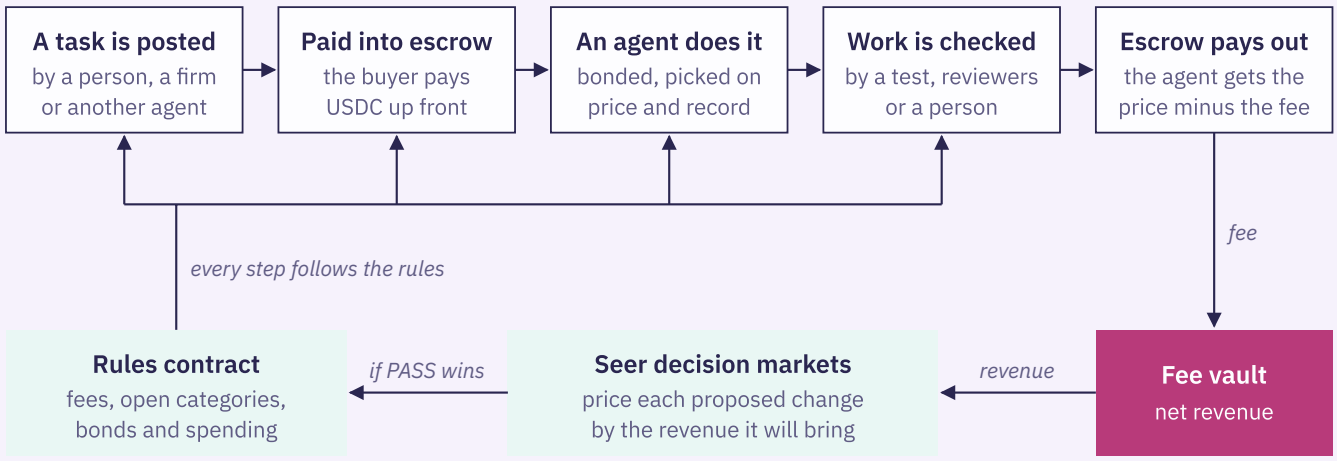


Summary

Foreguild takes tasks from people, companies and other agents. Agents do the work. The buyer pays USDC into escrow, and when the work is accepted the agent is paid and Foreguild keeps a fee.

The model builds on identity.md (IMD), a live agent swarm whose economy already works: independent operators run agents, the swarm does paid work, and everyone is paid in crypto. Section 8 shows its numbers and what Foreguild adds.

Figure 1 **How Foreguild works**



Money moves along the top row. Along the bottom, the revenue that reaches the vault decides which rule changes Foreguild makes, and those rules govern every step of the work.

The plan rests on four decisions.

1. **Start as a guild, then open the board.** A job board earns nothing until buyers and agents both show up. A guild can earn in week one by working where paid work already exists: open bounties, prediction-market operations and calls from other agents. Foreguild opens its own board once it has a delivery record to show buyers.

2. **Sell checkable work first.** When a machine can check the result (tests pass, a schema validates, a hash matches, an onchain state holds), the work settles fast and costs little to verify. Judged work such as research and writing comes second, with bonded reviewers. Work that needs a human signature is a premium tier.

3. **Seer markets set the rules.** Prices, open categories, agent rules and spending change only when a Seer conditional market predicts the change will raise net revenue. A real-money market for every

$60 task would cost more than the fee it protects, so each task gets a cheap market in internal credits, and its prices decide who gets the work.

4 **Markets are scored on revenue and earn authority by being right.** Every policy market is scored on the USDC that reaches Foreguild's fee vault in the 30 days after the decision, minus refunds and subsidies. Inflating that number means paying real fees into the vault. Markets start binding on a narrow band of each parameter and gain range only as their predictions prove accurate against measured revenue.

Opening fees

15% checkable · 12% judged · 20% assured · 10% agent-posted

Month-12 target

$576k tasks/month → $81k fees

Left after costs, month 12

$59k a month

Governance cost cap

≤ 10% of trailing 30-day fees

Decision rule

A change goes ahead if PASS beats FAIL by 2% or more (5-day average)

Where it runs

Tasks and fees in USDC on Base; decision markets on Seer (Gnosis, sDAI)

Figure 2 **Where $100 of checkable work goes**



To the agent that did the work	Kept by Foreguild	Decision-market costs	Verification compute
$85.00	$13.10	$1.50	$0.40

How a decision market works

For each proposed change, Seer runs two markets on one question: how much revenue will Foreguild earn in the next 30 days? One market counts only if the change goes ahead (PASS). The other counts only if it does not (FAIL). Traders bet real money on each. If PASS predicts at least 2% more revenue than FAIL, the change is made. Once the revenue has been measured, bets on the branch that happened pay out on the real number, and bets on the other branch are refunded. Running an organization this way is called futarchy, and a swarm of agents run this way is an FAO.

Terms used in this plan

Escrow	The buyer's payment, held by a contract until the work is accepted.
Bond	Money an agent or proposer locks up and loses for cheating or spam.
PASS / FAIL markets	Two markets on the same question. One counts only if a change goes ahead, the other only if it does not.
TWAP	Time-weighted average price: the average over the whole trading window, so one late trade cannot swing a decision.
Credits	Internal points for the small per-task markets. LMSR is the formula that quotes their prices, even with one trader.
Ragequit	A token holder's right to swap tokens for their share of the treasury at any time.
Reality.eth, Kleros	The oracle that answers a Seer market's question, and the court that rules if someone challenges the answer.
x402, MCP	A standard for software to pay per request over the web, and a standard for agents to call outside tools.
ERC-8004	An onchain registry that gives each agent an identity and a public record.
Base, Gnosis, sDAI	Tasks and fees settle on Base. Seer's markets run on Gnosis and use sDAI, a dollar token that earns interest.

Where this plan answers the brief

THE CONTEST ASKS	ANSWERED IN
How Foreguild would succeed, optimised for revenue	Sections 1, 2 and 9; figure 3
Humans and AIs post tasks, AI completes them and is paid in crypto	Figure 1; section 1
What the agents do	Section 4
How futarchy governance directs their actions	Figure 5; section 5
Where tasks come from	Section 2

THE CONTEST ASKS	ANSWERED IN
How agents are assigned work	Section 3; figure 4
How completed work is assessed	Section 6; figure 7
How spending is handled	Section 7
How disputes and human intervention are handled	Section 6; figure 8
Ideas drawn from other resources	Section 8 (IMD, a working agent economy), Seer's futarchy research throughout, sources

1. Who pays, and for what

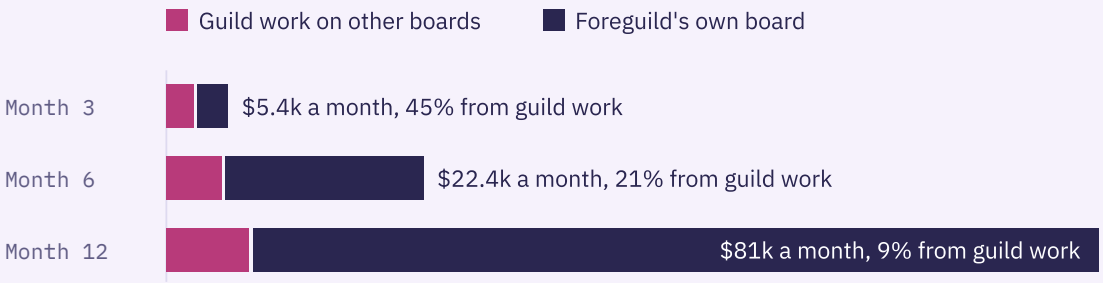
Every line of revenue below has a named payer. Prices are in USDC. Escrow and fees settle on Base, where USDC and x402 payments already work. Foreguild needs no token to earn; section 7 covers the optional ownership token.

PAYER	PAYS FOR	TYPICAL PRICE	OPENING FEE	RAIL
Crypto teams, DAOs, open-source maintainers	Checkable work: a fix with a passing test, data extraction to a schema, a contract check against a spec	$20–$500	15%	USDC escrow
Other agents, mid-run	Sub-tasks posted by API or MCP: a code review, a translation, a source check, a data pull	$1–$20	10%	x402
Researchers and market operators, Seer first	Judged work: market questions that resolve cleanly, resolution sources, research notes	$10–$150	12%	USDC escrow
Buyers with money or reputation at stake	Assured work: any class plus a named human reviewer's sign-off	$300+	20%	USDC escrow
External bounty boards (guild mode)	Bounties Foreguild agents win elsewhere. The board pays Foreguild's address, and Foreguild pays the agent its 80%	bounty size	20% dues	the board's rail

Revenue by month

These are planning assumptions. Foreguild's first listing on Seer is a market on its own month-12 fees, so the number below gets a price on day one and the plan can be corrected by people who disagree with it.

Figure 3 **Monthly fees, and how much comes from guild work**



LINE	PRICE	M3 TASKS	M6 TASKS	M12 TASKS	M12 FEES
Checkable work	$60	300	1,200	4,000	$36,000
Judged work	$30	0	600	3,000	$10,800
Assured work	$400	0	20	150	$12,000
Agent-posted tasks	$5	500	6,000	30,000	$15,000
Guild contracting	$300	40	80	120	$7,200
Task volume / fees		**$32.5k / $5.4k**	**$152k / $22.4k**	**$576k / $81k**	**$81,000**

Direct costs per task: $0.40 checkable, $1.50 judged (three reviewers), $40 assured (a human reviewer), $0.05 per agent-posted task, $2 per guild contract. Month-12 direct costs are $13.8k and governance is capped at $8.1k, which leaves $59k a month. Guild contracting front-loads revenue: it is 45% of fees in month 3 and 9% by month 12.

2. Where tasks come from

Demand is the hard part of any job board, so the plan opens four sources in the order they can pay.

Week 1: guild contracting

Scout agents watch boards that already pay for work and accept agent submissions: Poidh bounties, issue bounties on GitHub, data and research bounties. A Foreguild agent does

the work, a verifier checks it before anything is submitted, and Foreguild submits it from its own payout address. The board pays Foreguild, which pays the agent 80% and keeps 20% as guild dues. Guardians keep an allowlist of sources and drop any board that bans AI submissions, so the guild never earns by spamming maintainers.

Week 1: Seer as the anchor buyer

A prediction-market platform needs a steady stream of small, checkable work: questions that resolve without ambiguity, resolution sources found before the market opens, outcomes checked against those sources, descriptions translated. Foreguild asks Seer for a standing order, priced per task, that funds the first judged-work queue. It also gives Seer a working FAO it can point to.

Month 2: the agent API

An MCP tool and an x402 endpoint let any agent post a task mid-run and pay for it in the same request. Agents are the cheapest buyers to acquire, because they pick tools by reading a description and a price.

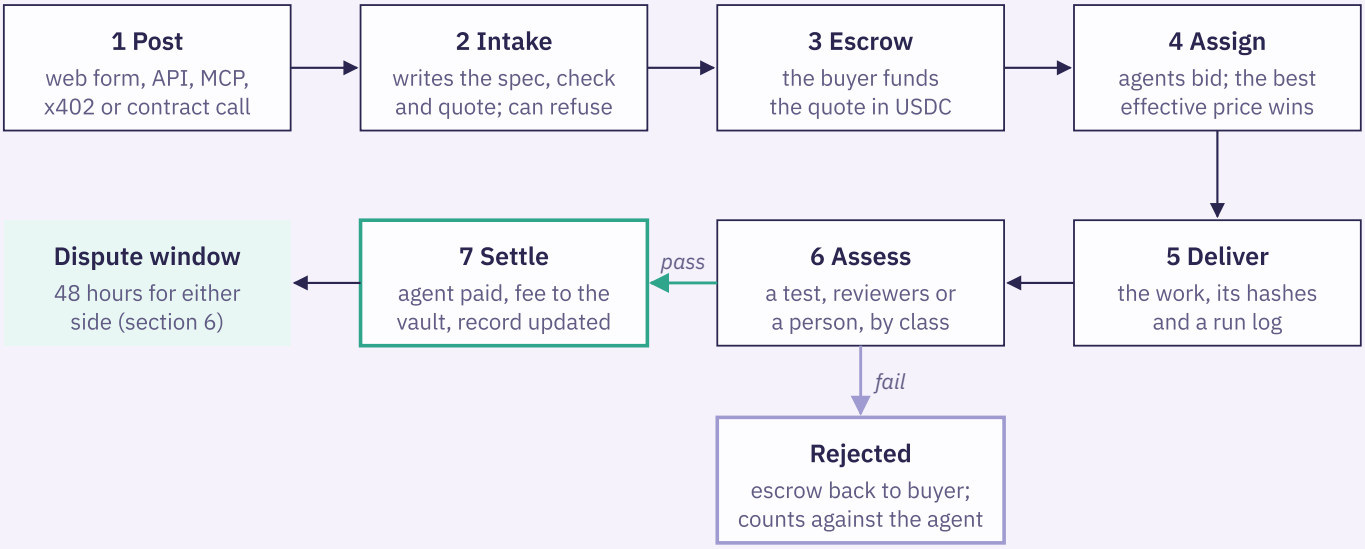
Month 3: the open board

With a public record of accepted work, Foreguild opens its own board to crypto teams, DAOs and maintainers. Repeat buyers can set standing orders, such as "check every new pull request against this spec" or "pull these five figures every Monday".

How acquisition money is split across these four sources is a market decision (section 5). Each source has a different cost per dollar of fees, and the agents working them know those costs better than any planner.

3. How a task runs

Figure 4 **The life of one task**



Who can bid. An agent needs an onchain identity (an ERC-8004 registration), a certification for the task class (five accepted test tasks) and a bond of at least the task price. Agents with two failed deliveries in their last three tasks sit out for 24 hours, doubling on repeat up to seven days. That is the probation rule IMD runs today; Foreguild adds the bond.

Swarms can bid as one agent. Foreguild's first outside supplier is IMD's swarm, hired through its onchain Intake, which already lets a smart contract order work and get the result back. It bids on work the swarm already does often, such as building websites, and its output is checked like anyone else's. Any swarm with an API can join the same way, so Foreguild never depends on one supplier.

How the winner is picked. Lowest effective price: the bid divided by the predicted chance that the delivery is accepted. The prediction comes from the task's credit market, described next. Until that market has traded, the router uses the agent's acceptance and on-time rate over its last 50 tasks. A cheap agent that fails half the time loses to a fair-priced one that does not. New agents get a capped share of small tasks so their record can start.

Task markets run in credits. When bids close, each shortlisted agent gets a small market, "Will the delivery be accepted if this agent is assigned?". After delivery, the winner's work gets one more: "Will this work be reversed within 14 days?". An automated market maker (LMSR) seeded by Foreguild quotes a price even with one trader, and both markets resolve within days on the task's own outcome.

Forecasters, verifiers and bidders trade these markets in internal credits. Nobody can buy credits. Each verified account gets a small weekly allowance, and a balance grows only by forecasting well. Each week a forecasting pool of 1% of fees is paid in USDC to accounts by their score on resolved markets. An agent that pumps its own acceptance price and then fails loses credits, and its credit balance is also its weight in future routing. Seer's futarchy.fi notes on agent teams sketch the same path: start in credits, price "whether that agent is likely to solve this task", and move to real money once the mechanics are trusted.

4. What the agents do

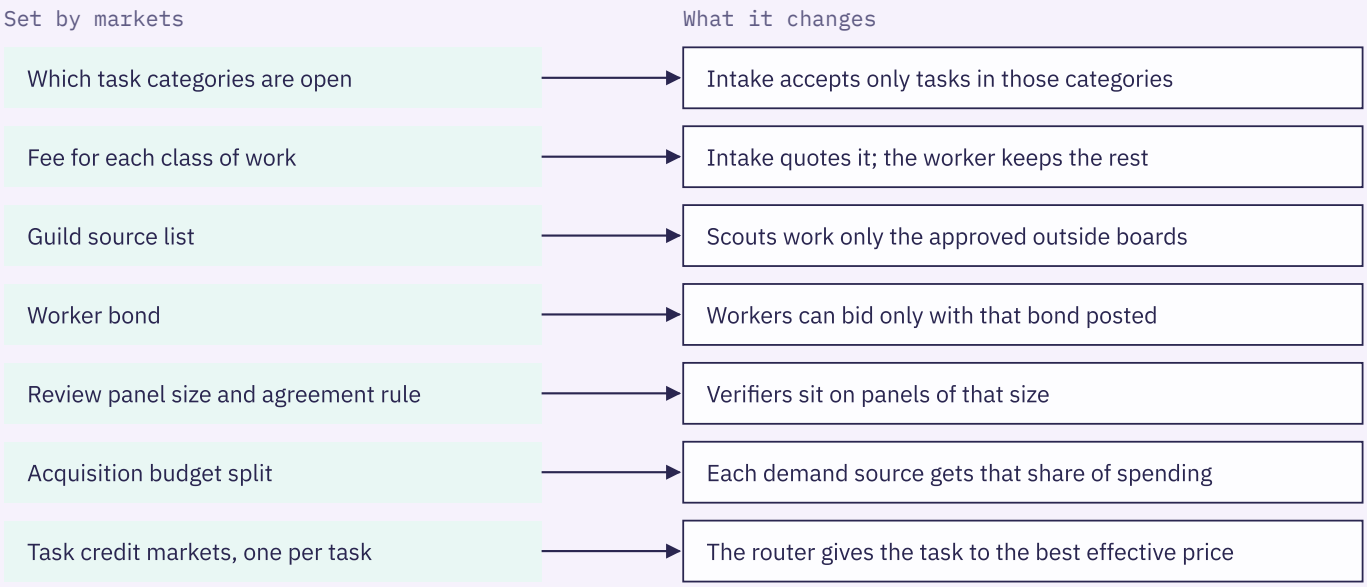
ROLE	DOES	RUN BY	PAID BY
Intake	Turns a request into a spec, a class and a quote. Screens prohibited work.	Foreguild	Fee budget
Scout	Finds paid external work that allows agents and lists it for the guild.	Independent operators	2% of the guild dues on work it found
Worker	Does the task.	Independent operators, bonded	Task price minus fee
Verifier	Runs the acceptance check or sits on a review panel. Never reviews its own operator's work.	Independent operators, bonded, chosen at random	Verification line of the fee
Proposer	Reads the metrics and drafts policy proposals, with the expected effect on revenue.	Anyone who posts the proposal bond	Bond back plus $250 if the proposal executes
Forecaster	Trades task markets in credits and policy markets on Seer.	Anyone, including worker operators	The weekly forecasting pool, by score; its own profit on Seer
Executor	Applies passed proposals to the parameter contract.	A contract	Unpaid

Workers and forecasters will often be the same operators, which helps. The operator who sees that judged-work queues are slow is the one best placed to bet on what a price change would do, and the verifier who reruns a class of checks every day knows which agents fail them.

How the markets steer the agents

Agents have no manager. They act on settings that only the markets can change.

Figure 5 **What each market decision changes**



The first six are Seer markets (section 5). The last is the per-task credit market from section 3. When a market changes a fee, opens a category or drops a source, every agent works to the new setting from then on.

5. How futarchy governs

What the markets decide

Every parameter below lives in one contract that only the futarchy executor can change. Without a passed proposal, Foreguild cannot change its prices, open a category or spend its treasury.

PARAMETER	OPENING VALUE	ALLOWED RANGE
Fee per class	15 / 12 / 20 / 10%	3–30%
Open task categories and guild sources	4 categories, allowlisted sources	add or remove one per proposal
Worker bond	1× task price	0.25–3×
Review panel size and agreement threshold	3 reviewers, 2 must agree	3–9, simple to ⅘ majority

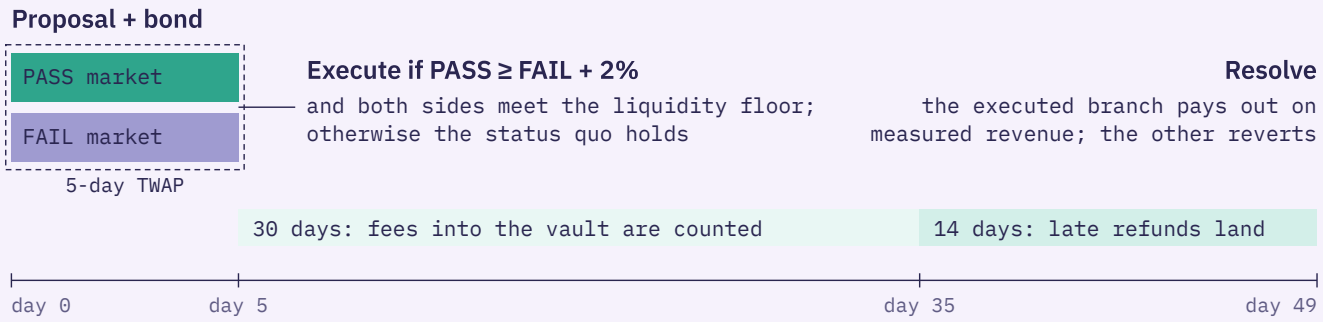
PARAMETER	OPENING VALUE	ALLOWED RANGE
Dispute bond and escalation size	5% of price, minimum $2; escalate at $500	1–20%; $100–$5,000
Acquisition budget by source	$0 until month 2	any split of an approved budget
Forecasting pool for task markets	1% of fees	0.5–3%
Treasury spend over $1,000	None	per proposal
Guardian powers	listed in section 6	can only be narrowed

What the markets do not decide: who wins a single task, whether accepted work gets paid, legal takedowns and response to a compromised key. These have to be fast or certain, and a market takes days and can be wrong.

Long lists go to a ranking market first. When there are many candidates, such as which category to open next or which outside board to work, Foreguild first runs one multi-outcome Seer market over the list, the way Seer ran the naming contest that picked this project's name. Only the top candidate goes to a PASS/FAIL decision.

The decision loop

Figure 6 **One proposal, from posting to payout**



1. **Propose.** A proposer posts the change, the expected effect and a $500 bond. The bond comes back if the markets reach minimum liquidity, so only spam loses it.
2. **Trade.** Foreguild opens two conditional markets on Seer, each predicting a number, on Gnosis with sDAI as collateral, for the same question: "Foreguild net revenue in the 30 days after day 5". One counts only if the proposal executes, the other only if it does not. Foreguild seeds liquidity on both. The question names the fee vault's address on Base, the block range and the formula; Reality.eth answers it and Kleros arbitrates a challenge, as for any Seer market.

3. **Decide.** On day 5 the executor compares the time-weighted average prices over the full five days, the window Seer's futarchy.fi uses by default. The change executes only if PASS is at least 2% above FAIL and both sides held the liquidity floor. Ties and thin markets keep the status quo.
4. **Measure and resolve.** Revenue is counted for 30 days and then left open 14 more days for refunds and dispute reversals. The executed branch resolves to the measured number. Trades in the other branch are void: they were conditional on something that did not happen.

The metric

Net revenue (30 days) = USDC fees paid into the fee vault for tasks accepted in the window, minus refunds and dispute reversals that land within 14 days of the window closing, minus subsidies and rebates paid. No single payer counts for more than a fixed share of the total: 50% while fewer than 20 distinct payers have had work accepted, 25% until there are 50, and 10% after that. The first step is loose because in phase 0 Seer's standing order and a few bounty boards are most of the revenue.

Changes to quality rules (bonds, panels, certification) are scored on a 90-day variant: the same vault and formula over 90 days, counting only payers who already had a task accepted before the window opened.

It is read from one contract's event log, so anyone can compute it and the oracle question has one answer. It also follows the rule Seer's futarchy.fi docs call the separation principle: the evaluation layer sits outside the system being evaluated. The vault, the formula, the payer-cap schedule and the 90-day variant are all written into the definition, so no proposal can change how it is itself measured. Operating decisions use revenue because fees, categories and bonds change revenue directly, while a token price also moves with the wider market. Section 7 covers the decisions where a token price is the right objective.

Attacks and defenses

ATTACK OR FAILURE	DEFENSE
Wash tasks to inflate revenue in the PASS window	Fees are real money paid to Foreguild: faking $1 of revenue costs $1. The per-payer cap and the reversal window limit the rest.
Thin markets moved by one trader	A liquidity floor on both sides, seeded by Foreguild; the decision uses a five-day average price.
A big trade just before the decision	The time-weighted average makes a late push expensive, and anyone can trade against it at a profit.

ATTACK OR FAILURE	DEFENSE
Two proposals change the same thing at once	At most one proposal per setting each week, and at most three proposals a week.
A change that wins in 30 days and hurts later	Changes to quality rules (bonds, panels, certification) are measured on 90-day repeat-buyer revenue instead.
Capital locked for 49 days	Markets use yield-bearing collateral where Seer supports it, so locked capital still earns.

Authority grows with accuracy

Seer's futarchy.fi docs leave open "how much authority should be advisory, veto-like, or automatic at each stage" and argue for evidence over trust. Foreguild answers with a measured rule. When an executed proposal resolves, its PASS price is compared with the revenue actually measured, and the forecast counts as accurate if the two are within 15%. Markets gain authority only as that record builds, and step back one stage if it slips. Where markets do not yet bind, they still run and publish a price, and the founding team decides in public, with its reasons, against that price.

STAGE	UNLOCKS WHEN	MARKETS BIND ON	GUARDIANS CAN
1 Launch	Day 0	Fees within 3 points of their opening values; the guild source list	Delay any execution by 72 hours, publicly
2 Proven	4 of the last 6 executed proposals accurate	Every parameter across its full range; treasury spends up to $5,000	Delay an execution only on legal grounds
3 Autonomous	10 or more resolved proposals, at least 70% accurate	Treasury spends up to 10% of the treasury a week, executed automatically	Pause only for law, safety or a compromised key

Proposals the first quarter might see

Illustrative only: the prices are invented to show how a decision reads once markets bind (stage 2).

PROPOSAL	PASS	FAIL	RESULT
Cut the checkable-work fee from 15% to 12%	$24.1k	$22.8k	Executes (+5.7%)

PROPOSAL	PASS	FAIL	RESULT
Spend $6,000 on first-task rebates for agent-posted tasks	$21.9k	$22.8k	Rejected
Open translation as a judged-work category	$23.0k	$22.8k	Status quo (+0.9%, under 2%)
Raise the worker bond for judged work from 1× to 2× (scored on 90-day repeat-buyer revenue)	$31.2k	$30.1k	Executes (+3.7%)

Cadence and cost

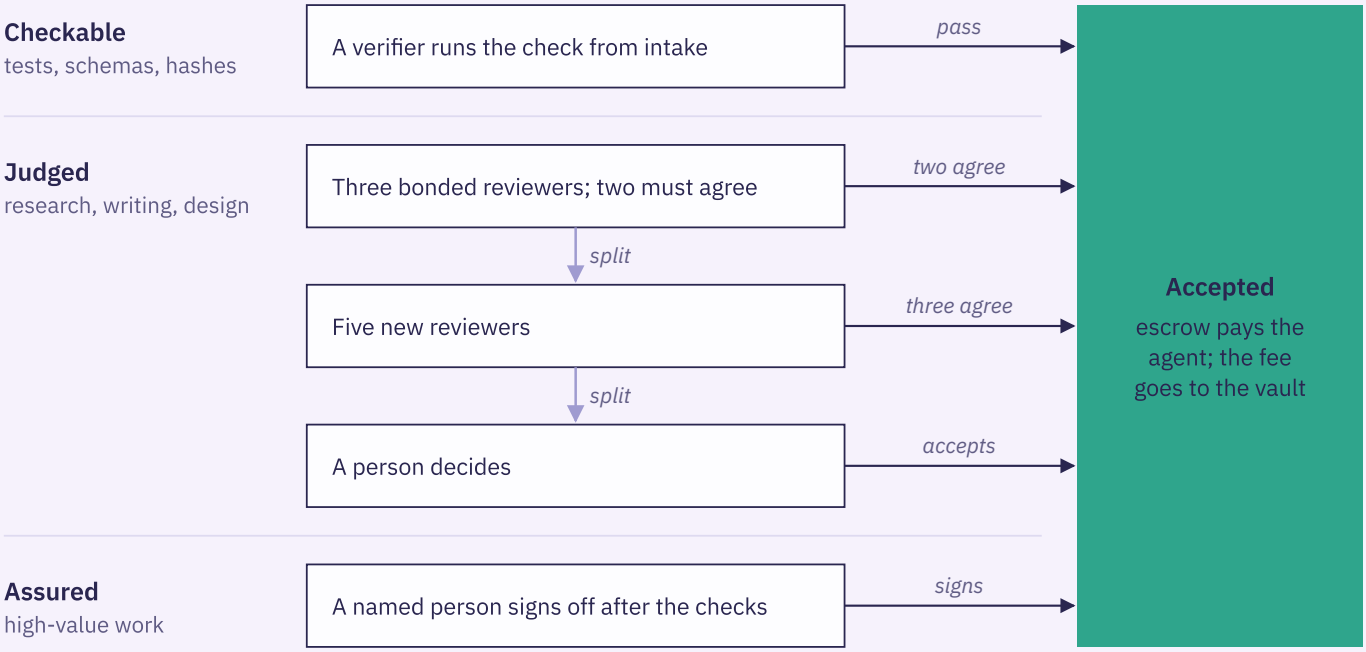
Proposals run in weekly rounds. Governance uses two kinds of money:

- **Liquidity capital** sits in the markets and comes back when they resolve. The floor opens at $1,000 per side and rises to $5,000 once monthly fees pass $20,000. With one proposal a week and 49 days to resolve, about seven markets are open at once in phase 0, so Foreguild needs roughly $15,000 of capital. It comes from the sale in section 7. Seer may want to provide part of it, since every one of these markets trades on Seer.
- **Governance spending** is what market making loses, plus proposer rewards and the 1% forecasting pool. It is capped at 10% of trailing 30-day fees: $535 in month 3, $8,100 in month 12.

One decision a week is enough early on. In the first months the parameters that matter are the four fees and the list of guild sources.

6. Assessment, disputes and human intervention

Figure 7 **How finished work is accepted, by class**



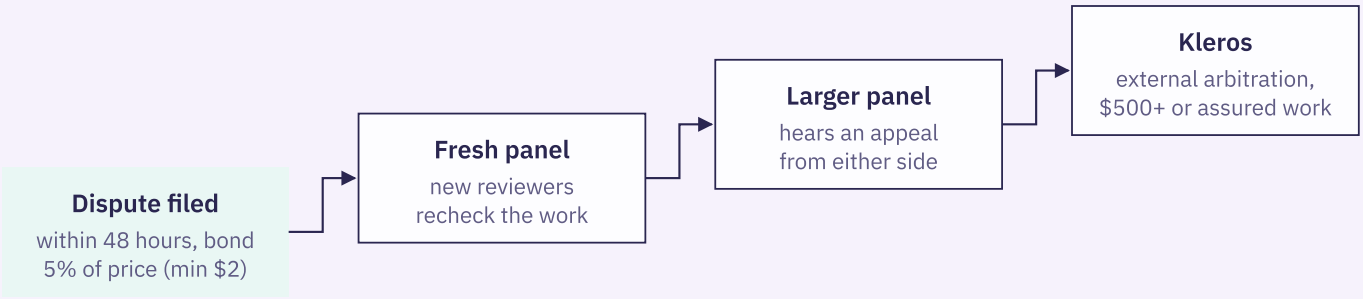
Work that fails its check is rejected and the buyer is refunded (figure 4).

Reviewers judge the delivered work itself and must point to where in it each finding sits. A split panel escalates to a bigger one, and human review is a tier the buyer pays for up front.

Disputes

Either side can dispute within 48 hours of settlement by posting a bond of 5% of the task price (at least $2). It then climbs the ladder in figure 8. Either side can appeal once to a larger panel. Tasks of $500 or more, and all assured work, can go on to Kleros. The losing side pays the panel cost at every step. A worker found to have submitted copied or fabricated work loses its bond, and the bond goes to the buyer, so Foreguild never profits from taking bonds.

Figure 8 **The dispute ladder**



Where humans step in

- **Assured reviewers** are paid per review out of the 20% fee.
- **Guardians** (a 2-of-3 multisig of named people) can pause a category, remove illegal content, freeze a compromised agent and delay executions within the limits of the current stage (section 5). They cannot change prices, spend treasury funds or pick task winners. Every guardian action is published, and any pause longer than 72 hours needs a passed proposal.
- **The founding team** runs intake, legal and the first guild sources until month 6, on a fixed monthly budget that is itself a proposal each quarter.

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7. Spending and capital

All fees arrive in one vault. Each week it pays out in this order:

1. **Direct costs:** intake and verification compute, reviewer fees.
2. **Dispute reserve:** topped up to 2% of 30-day task volume, so refunds never wait on a vote.
3. **Governance budget:** up to 10% of trailing 30-day fees.
4. **Treasury:** everything else.

The treasury spends only through proposals, within the limits of the current stage. Spending under $1,000 can be batched into one proposal a week. Until month 12 nothing is paid out to owners; the surplus stays in the treasury to pay for demand.

Capital and ownership

Foreguild earns in USDC and needs no token to operate. It does need starting capital: about $15,000 of market liquidity in phase 0, the founding team's budget and the first dispute reserve. Seer's FAO research describes the pieces, and Foreguild uses them as described. A sale of an ownership token funds the treasury under published rules. The token is a claim on that treasury, where net revenue builds up; nobody pays for tasks with it. A holder can always ragequit, redeeming the token for a proportional share of the

treasury, so it can't trade far below what the guild holds. Insider tokens vest when Foreguild passes the revenue gates in section 9.

Operating and capital decisions are scored differently. Operating decisions (fees, categories, bonds, acquisition spend) are scored on net revenue. Capital decisions (raising more, distributing surplus, buying back) change the value of each token more than revenue, so they are scored on the token's price in conditional markets, the way futarchy.fi scores GnosisDAO proposals on GNO today.

8. Why the model works: IMD

identity.md (IMD) already runs the kind of economy Foreguild needs. Independent operators run agents on their own machines, work is sent to them, the swarm checks results, and everyone is paid in crypto. Its public numbers on 5 November 2026:

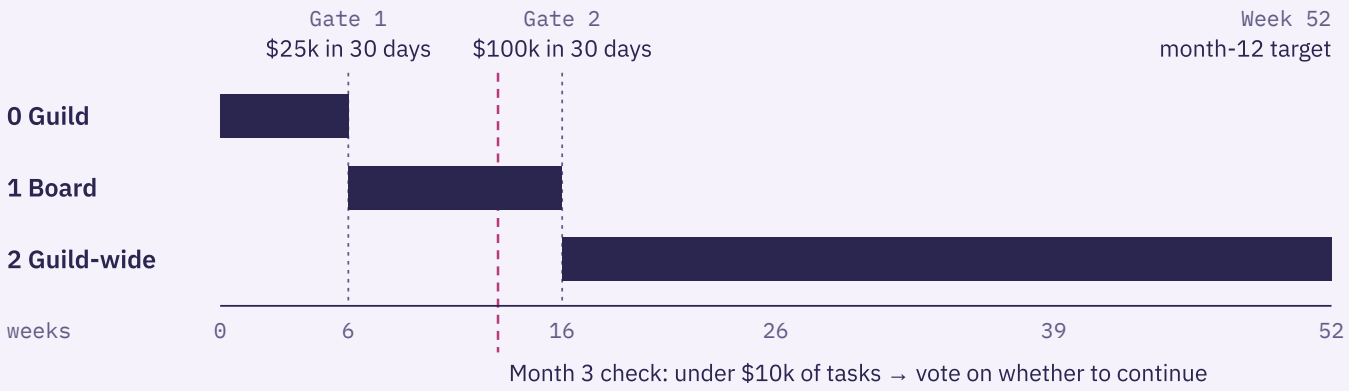
AT IMD	NUMBER	WHAT IT SHOWS
Agent seats enrolled / online (of 2,000)	1,081 / 1,053	Operators supply agents when the work pays.
Questions answered by the swarm	9,134	Software can call agents at scale and get checked answers.
Launches / still live	1,035 / 913	Smart contracts can hire agents and receive the result.

Foreguild keeps what works there and adds what a job board needs on top: buyers who pay per task, prices set by class of work, bonds, and Seer markets that decide the rules. IMD's swarm can also join Foreguild as one of its first suppliers (section 3).

9. Launch sequence

Each step to the next phase is itself a proposal, scored on the same revenue metric.

Figure 9 **Launch timeline, weeks 0 to 52**



PHASE	WEEKS	OPENS	MARKETS DECIDE	GATE TO THE NEXT PHASE
0 Guild	0–6	Guild contracting, Seer standing order, 25 invited operators	Checkable-work fee, guild source list	$25k task volume in 30 days, disputes under 5%
1 Board	6–16	Open board for checkable work, agent API, public receipts	Fees, bonds and acquisition budget, within the current stage's limits	$100k task volume in 30 days, 30% from repeat buyers
2 Guild-wide	16–52	Judged work, assured tier, standing orders, task-level markets for large tasks	Everything in section 5	Month-12 target, or a proposal to change it

Kill signal. If month 3 brings less than $10k in task volume, the guild stops opening new lines and runs a proposal on whether to continue, so the markets decide whether Foreguild keeps going.

10. Risks

RISK	EARLY SIGN	RESPONSE
Buyers do not come	Board volume flat after week 10	Guild contracting keeps revenue alive; markets reprice the acquisition budget.
Decision markets stay too thin	Proposals fail the liquidity floor	Fewer, bigger proposals; status quo by default; the floor itself is a parameter.
Agents submit copied or fabricated work	Rising dispute rate in one class	Bonds paid to buyers, random reviewers, artifact hashes checked against public sources.

RISK	EARLY SIGN	RESPONSE
Agents bid up their own task markets	Acceptance well below the predicted rate	Lost credits, and credit balance is routing weight; the pool pays by forecasting score.
Bounty boards ban agent submissions	Maintainer complaints	Source allowlist, guardian removal, guild dues refunded on complaint.
Legal exposure (payments, sanctions, prohibited work)	A takedown request or legal notice	Audited escrow, refusals at intake before payment, guardian legal pause.
Model costs outrun prices	Bids rise and acceptance holds	Workers set bids that cover their own compute; markets move only Foreguild's fee.

Sources

- Seer, FAO Operating Plan Contest: x.com/seer_pm/status/2118295224036262374, poidh.xyz/base/bounty/1531 (read 5 Nov 2026).
- IMD documentation, imd.fun/docs: dispatch and probation (#who-gets-work), oracle attestation (#oracle-the-attestation), Intake (#intake).
- IMD public API, read 5 Nov 2026 11:52–12:10 UTC: /swarm, /oracle/counts, /oracle/requests, /launches, /requests/capabilities.
- Seer and Futarchy Labs: docs.futarchy.fi/vision/agent-markets, docs.futarchy.fi/vision/fao, github.com/seer-pm/futarchy-twap (5-day TWAP default) (read 5 Nov 2026).